

Thé ou café

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Taking the time to connect over a hot drink.

An interactive story lasting about five minutes, envisioned to be played on an iPad. Inspired by the night patrols conducted in Geneva by social workers' associations, it explores various encounters with people living on the streets through moments of presence and human connection.

The visitor is invited to slow down and listen. The time devoted to each conversation depends on the simple act of pouring a glass of a hot drink: the longer it is filled, the more the story unfolds.

As the seasons go past, relationships evolve and fragments of lives emerge gradually - sometimes quiet, sometimes unexpected. Some connections form instantly; others require patience and repeated visits.

The narrative is conveyed exclusively through voice and is inspired by testimonies gathered during the research phase from social workers and people with lived experience of homelessness.



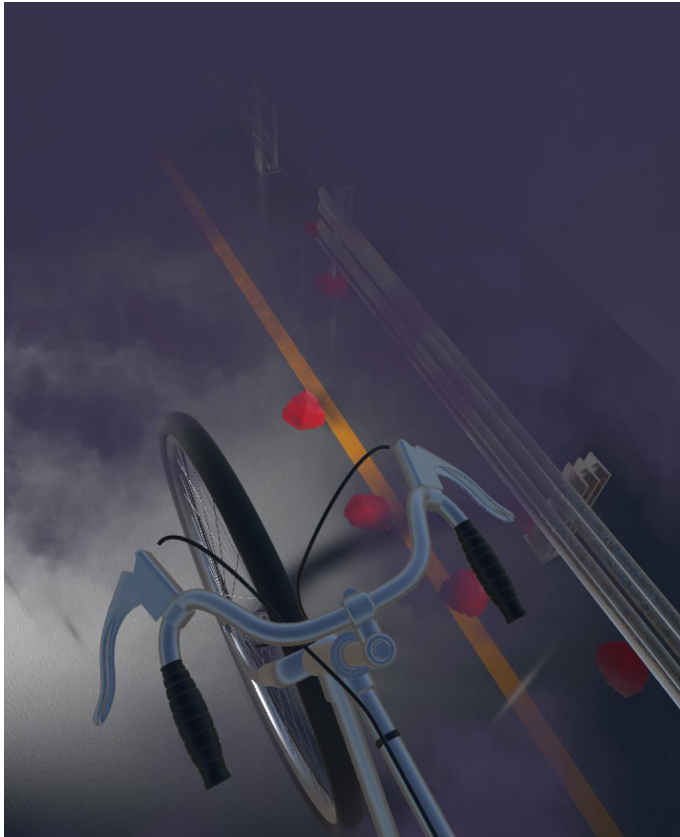
User Journey

The visitor discovers a bicycle moving through the streets in autumn. By pressing and holding the screen, the user slows down and stops the bicycle until they are faced with an empty cup.

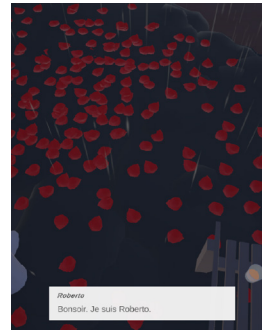
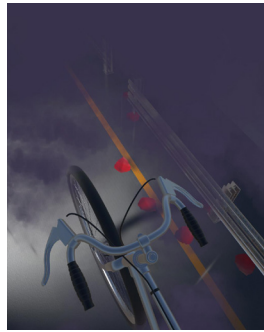
The amount used to fill the cup determines the duration of the exchange: the fuller the cup, the longer the conversation unfolds. The user chooses how much they give. This interaction leads to a meeting with Roberto, who slowly reveals more of his personality.

At the end of each exchange, the user returns to the moving bicycle. This sequence marks the transition to a new season and becomes a recurring ritual between encounters. Season after season, the same cycle repeats: bicycle, stop, give, and meet Roberto. Through these repeated interactions, a relationship develops.

The story ends with one final return to the bicycle in summer. This time, after stopping, Roberto does not appear. His absence remains ambiguous: it is unclear whether he has left, whether he is



autumn



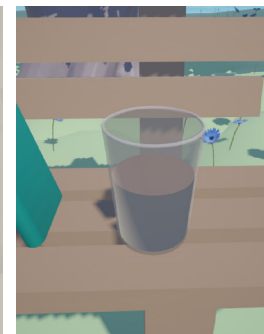
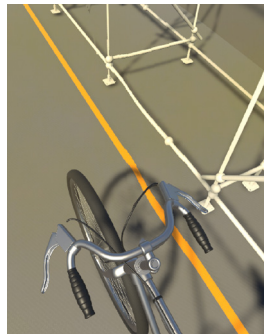
winter



spring



summer



Final Production

The interactive experience is already fully functional as a standalone work, and the current narrative around Roberto is complete. If selected for exhibition, additional production would focus on refining and enriching the existing experience rather than substantially changing it.

1. Voice recordings: The current dialogues are inspired by testimonies collected during the research phase. Given more time, we would seek to record the voices of the people who inspired the stories. In particular, we would welcome the opportunity to record the person whose experiences inspired Roberto, should he feel comfortable participating.
2. Technical polish: Further production time would allow improvements to the synchronization between dialogue and interaction, smoother scene transitions, and more varied camera movements during bicycle sequences and conversations.
3. Sound design: Ambient recordings could be expanded and refined, with the addition of a subtle musical layer to reinforce the atmosphere and rhythm of the narrative.
4. Exhibition presentation: Although the experience is designed as an infinite loop, a main title could be added after the autumnal bike scene to provide visitors with a clearer sense of the beginning and end of a narrative cycle within the exhibition context.
5. Expansion of the narrative: Building on the research conducted during the project, two additional stories - those of Magla and Fernand, originally conceived for locations under a bridge and in the train station hall - could be integrated into the experience. Following the same interaction mechanics and seasonal progression, these parallel narratives would broaden the portrayal of life on the streets while remaining faithful to the original concept.

